LOCAL RUN & SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

CareerTrack – MERN Major Project

1. Configure MongoDB

Start local MongoDB or create an Atlas cluster. Copy backend/.env.example to backend/.env and set MONGO_URI, JWT_SECRET, ADMIN_EMAIL and ADMIN_PASSWORD.

2. Start backend

From backend/: npm install → npm run seed:admin → npm run seed:jobs → npm run dev.

3. Start frontend

Copy frontend/.env.example to frontend/.env, set VITE_API_URL, then run npm install and npm run dev.

4. Verify workflows

Browse jobs; submit a guest application with a test résumé; sign in as admin; create/publish a job; update an application status; export CSV; verify unauthorized requests are blocked.

5. Complete evidence

Capture genuine screenshots and update Test_Cases.xlsx with actual outcomes. Replace PENDING deployment and GitHub links only after publication.

6. Final safety review

Ensure .env, real résumés, personal candidate data and credentials are excluded from Git. Change demo admin password and use HTTPS/private storage for deployment.